- Maximizing *agricultural income* is among the most immediate issues of attention – while adopting a more sustainable agricultural strategy. The concerns here are land and *water degradation* due to soil erosion, *soil salinity*, *water logging*, and *excessive application of nutrients*. There are concerns arising also from over-exploitation of water resources, especially in the ***Green Revolution*** belt.
- Better management practices for rehabilitation of degraded land and water resources hold the key – measures must be taken to promote use of quality seeds, cultivation of drought-resistant varieties of crops, judicious use of available water, balanced use of fertilizers, farm mechanization to improve efficiency levels, and wider use of irrigation facilities. Expenditure on agricultural research also needs to be stepped up substantially.
- *Climate change* and *extreme weather* events with greater intensity and frequency can have serious implications for our agriculture sector and create greater instability in food production and thereby farmers' livelihood. The current crop insurance cater to the unavoidable climatic conditions or pest epidemics.
- Declining *per capita availability of foodgrains* has been a major concern in India. For ensuring nutritional security, it is not only important to increase per capita availability of foodgrains but also to ensure the right amounts of food items in the food basket of the common man. A thrust on horticulture products and protein-rich items is required for enhancing per capita availability of food items as well as ensuring nutritional security.
- Agricultural growth in the *eastern and north-eastern regions* has been slower than in the rest of the country – the good prospects of production in many crops in these parts of the country should quickly be taken advantage of in the years to come. Hence ***a strategy*** for agricultural development in eastern and north-eastern India comprising multiple livelihood opportunities, sustainable agricultural development through a farming systems approach, efficient national resources management, ecoregional technology missions, and rice-based farming systems needs to be put in place.